

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS

FILE 99 · THE SOLUTION

The **Thistledown** *Supper*

A Cozy Dinner Party Murder Mystery

4-8 PLAYERS

2-2.5 HOURS

PRINTABLE PDF

STOP.



Open only after everyone has voted.

This file contains the answer. Print it without reading it and seal it in an envelope. After the ballots are collected, any player may open it and read Script 5 aloud.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

US LETTER + A4

Sage Whitlock, the family solicitor.



How: at about six o'clock, while Barty was in the garden, Sage stirred two sachets of Sage's own Dormital sleeping powder into Barty's waiting glass of cordial, burnt the papers in the study fire and left a note under the saucer as an excuse. **Why:** Sage had taken £4,000 from the Thistle Trust, and Barty meant to expose it on Monday.



The clue chain: six steps

1

The powder went into the glass, not the bottle.

Barty's glass held white grains; the bottle had none, and Dot drank from it safely at 6:50. Whoever did this came to the glass after it was poured.

(E1)

2

The glass stood alone in the study from 5:45 to about 6:25.

Morgan poured it at 5:45, covered it with a saucer and saw Barty go out to the garden, with nothing else on the desk. Barty's ledger puts Barty in the garden at 5:50 and 6:20; Rowan heard Barty back in the hall at about 6:25.

(E2) (Booklet 12 · Morgan · Round 1) (Booklet 10 · Rowan · Round 3)

3

Three core suspects could not reach it.

Rowan and Ellis were together in the drawing room from 5:45 to 6:30. Cook's slate keeps Morgan in the kitchen from 5:50 to 6:30, and shows the library empty and cold at 6:10, so anyone claiming a quiet hour in the library is not telling the truth.

(E9) (Booklet 10 · Rowan · Round 1) (Booklet 11 · Ellis · Round 1)

4

Sage stood at the glass after it was poured.

The note under the saucer is in green ink, signed "S." Sage writes in green ink. The desk was bare at 5:35–5:42 (Rowan) and again at 5:45 when Morgan set the saucer down, so the note went under it later, in the empty hour.

(E5) (E3) (Booklet 12 · Morgan · Round 1) (Booklet 10 · Rowan · Round 2)

5

The sleeping powder came from Sage's own box.

Two Dormital sachets were burnt in the study grate. Sage's box in the Blue Room was dispensed this morning with six sachets; four remain. Four plus two makes six. Ellis has prescribed Dormital to nobody else at the table.

(E4) (E7) (Booklet 11 · Ellis · Round 2)

6

Sage had the reason.

£4,000 had left the Thistle Trust, every withdrawal signed by the trustee, and Barty meant to hand the Trust to a London firm on Monday. Sage is the sole trustee, and Barty had told Sage "Every penny... by Monday" at 5:15.

(E8) (E3) (Booklet 12 · Morgan · Round 2) (Booklet 11 · Ellis · Round 3)

Why Not the Others

SEVEN SUSPECTS, SEVEN ALIBIS

Every suspect had a motive and something that looked bad. Here is why each of the other seven is in the clear. (Optional characters 14–17 only appear if they were cast.)

SUSPECT	MOTIVE	RED HERRING	CLEARED BY
Rowan Thistle HEIR TO THISTLEDOWN HOUSE	Inherits the house; Barty refused a £200 loan tonight.	The torn check (E6) and a visit to the study at 5:35.	At the piano with Ellis from 5:45 to 6:30. Left the study before the glass was even poured.
Ellis Fairweather FAMILY DOCTOR	Barty withdrew £1,000 promised for the hospital wing.	Dormital is Ellis's prescription (E4).	By the drawing-room fire with Rowan the whole hour. No Dormital in the bag; the sachets match Sage's box (E7).
Morgan Pike STEWARD OF THISTLEDOWN HOUSE	Barty's will leaves Morgan the gate lodge and £500.	Poured the glass and handled the bottle.	Poured in front of Barty, with no powder in the bottle (E1). In the kitchen 5:50–6:30 (E9).
Harper Vale FOOD CRITIC	Barty was suing Harper over a cruel jam review.	Wandered down the study corridor at 5:40.	In the dining room, then on the hall telephone 6:10–6:25, in Jules's view; no Dormital.
Quinn Ashby HEAD GARDENER	Barty planned to sell the walled garden.	Made the cordial itself.	With Barty in the kitchen garden 5:50–6:20 (E2). The bottle was clean (E1).
Avery Lark NEWSPAPER REPORTER	An anonymous tip promised a story about the Trust.	Crept into the study at 6:40.	Arrived by taxi at 6:30, after the glass had been dosed and drunk; Barty was already asleep.
Jules Marchetti VISITING CHEF	Barty meant to sell Jules's jam recipe without credit.	Shouted "You will regret this supper!" at four.	In the dining room 5:45–6:30 with Harper in view; heard the study door at 6:05 rather than using it.

Script 5 • The Reveal

ANY PLAYER READS THIS ALOUD

READ ALOUD, SLOWLY

The plates are cleared, the ballots are in, and the candles are burning low. Here is what happened at Thistledown House tonight.

At a quarter to six, Morgan poured Barty's glass of elderflower cordial, set a saucer on top and watched Barty stroll out to the kitchen garden. For the next forty minutes that glass stood alone in the study.

Rowan was at the piano, with Ellis listening by the fire. Morgan was down in the kitchen, polishing silver under Cook's eye. And the library, where one guest claims to have spent the whole hour, was empty and cold.

Because at about six o'clock, someone slipped into the study, lifted that saucer and stirred two sachets of sleeping powder into the glass. The papers went into the fire. And a little note in green ink went under the saucer, ready as an excuse.

That note gave the game away. Only one person at this table writes in green ink. Only one person had a box of Dormital, dispensed this very morning, with exactly two sachets missing. And only one person had taken £4,000 from the Thistle Trust, and heard Barty promise to tell the world on Monday.

Barty came in from the garden at twenty-five past six, sat down with that glass for a rest, and never woke up.

Ladies, gentlemen and honored guests, it was **Sage Whitlock**, the family solicitor.

Pause. Let the table react. Sage, would you like to say a few words in your own defense?

When the Inspector arrives at first light, there will be a great deal of paperwork. Sage, of all people, will understand. To Barty, and to Thistledown.

Scoring & Awards



Answer key

ON THE BALLOT	CORRECT ANSWER	POINTS
Who	Sage Whitlock	3
How	Sleeping powder (Dormital) stirred into Barty's glass of cordial	1
Why	To hide the £4,000 taken from the Thistle Trust before Barty exposed it on Monday	1
Key evidence	Any of E1, E2, E3, E4, E5, E7, E8, E9 (E6 is a red herring)	1 each, up to 3
Sage's player	3 points if half the table or fewer named Sage	3

Best Detective: the highest score. Break a tie with the best-argued “Why.” **Best Performance:** a show of hands for the most convincing character. Certificates are in file 34.



What really happened: the full timeline

TIME	EVENT
5:00–5:15	Ellis checks Barty's heart in the study: steady. Barty says the hospital money must wait.
5:15–5:35	Sage meets Barty in the study. “Every penny, Sage. By Monday.”
5:35–5:42	Rowan asks Barty for £200; the check is torn up. The desk is bare.
5:45	Morgan pours the cordial and covers it with a saucer. Barty goes out to the garden.
5:45–6:30	Rowan at the piano, Ellis listening. Morgan in the kitchen from 5:50.
about 6:00–6:08	Sage doses the glass, burns the sachets, leaves the note and goes upstairs.
6:10–6:15	Dot finds the library empty and cold.
about 6:25	Barty comes in from the garden, drinks the cordial and sits down to rest.
6:45	Morgan finds Barty asleep and cannot wake Barty. Ellis is called.